MEASURECAMP DC · A DISCUSSION

525,600

minutes. How do you measure a year?

Lived learning, meaning and the future of measurement

Michael Robbins · michael@intospatia.xyz · dotes.xyz · CC BY 4.0

WHAT WE COUNT

We know how to count them.

Hours

spent in classrooms

Courses

completed

Badges

earned

Clicks

made, logged and modeled

WHAT WE MISS

But how do we measure what people actually live?

What they experience.

What they discover.

What they overcome.

The relationships they build.

The people they become.

A SHOW OF HANDS

1 Hands up if you know how many sessions your site had last month.

2 Keep it up if you can tell me what one of those visitors learned.

QUICK WRITE

On your card: one thing you learned this year that no system recorded.

First names only. Nobody collects these cards.

3:00

MINUTES

THE GAP

We measure what people do inside our systems.

We almost never ask them what it meant.

WHY IT MATTERS NOW

Inference is already building identities.

TODAY

Ad platforms infer your interests.

TODAY

Risk models infer your reliability.

NEXT

AI agents that speak for us, built from those guesses.

If we don’t author our own identities, AI will infer them for us.

THE QUESTION

What if the evidence of all that learning belonged to the person who lived it?

DOTES

A way to record what you learned by living it, in your own words, in a form AI can read.

Descended from show-and-tell: This is mine. This is what I did. This is why it matters.

THE FORMAL DEFINITION

An AI-ready narrative ontology for the first-person recordation of lived learning experiences. Axiomatic to narrative and relational identity development and the cultivation of AI Representatives.

THE STRUCTURE

Every dote has five parts.

D

Do

What happened, and what did you do?

O

Observe

What went well, what didn’t, what did you learn?

T

Tell

How would you tell it to someone else?

E

Explore

What would you do differently, and what are you still wondering?

S

Show

What makes it real?

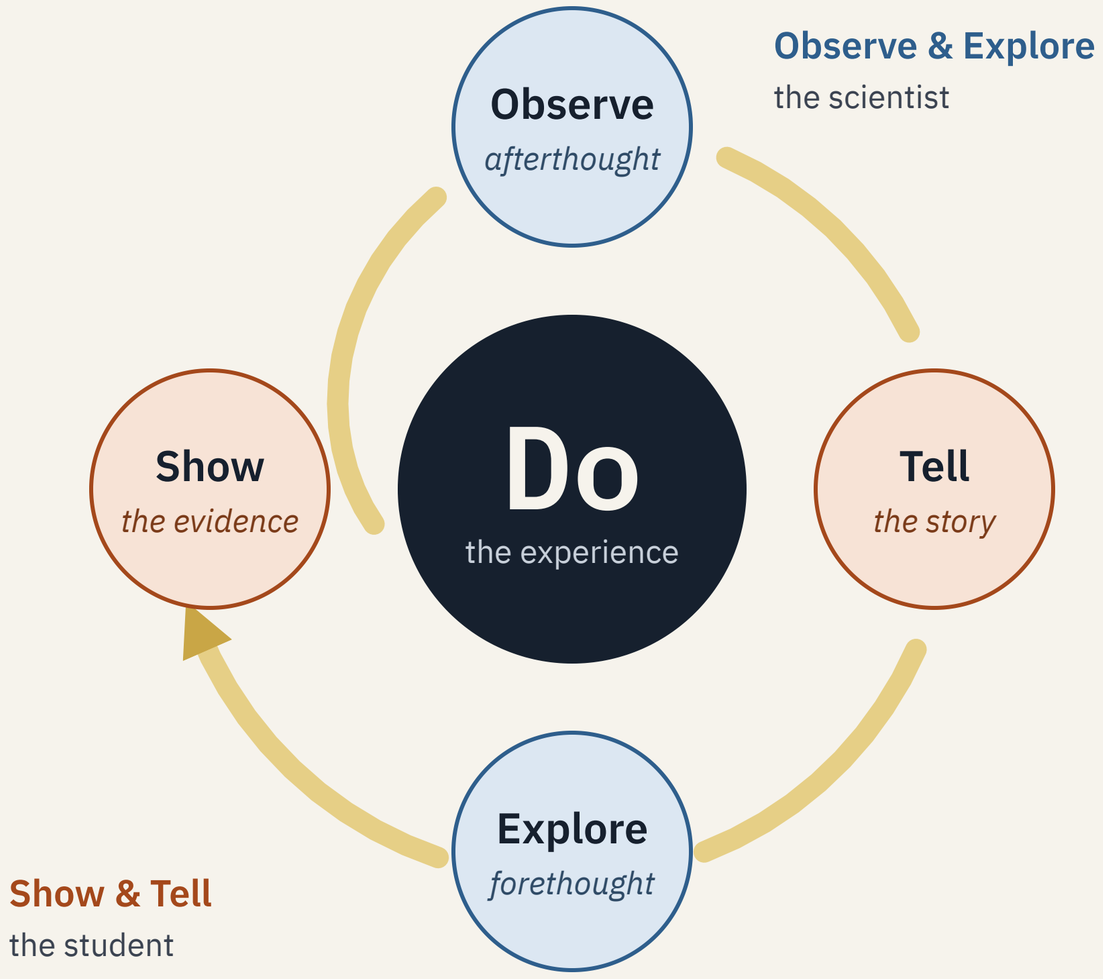
Do is the record. **Tell** is the story. The machine helps with the medium; the person holds the meaning.

THE SHAPE OF A DOTE

Every dote is a spiral.

It starts at Do, the experience, and moves outward through Observe, Tell, Explore and Show.

Each turn widens the circle of meaning around the same experience.



TWO TRADITIONS, ONE SHAPE

Show and tell, meet the scientist.

THE STUDENT

Show & Tell

Hold something up and say what it means: this is mine, this is what I did, this is why it matters.

THE SCIENTIST

Observe & Explore

Loosely the scientific method: look closely at what happened, then ask what to try next, and try it.

***Observe** is afterthought: the look back.*

***Explore** is forethought: the look ahead.*

ONE DOTE

A first summer job

Do	Junior counselor at a rec center day camp. In week two, two eight-year-olds started shoving over the kickball, and I had to handle it.
Observe	Taking the ball away made it worse. Hearing each kid out, separately, worked. Being fair and being in charge are different things.
Tell	“Same story: each of them thought it was his turn. We made a rule that afternoon: whoever lost the last round picks first. By Friday, the kids were enforcing it themselves.”
Explore	Apply for senior counselor next summer. How do coaches learn to settle arguments?
Show	A photo of the rule on the camp whiteboard. A note from the senior counselor.

FAMILIAR TOOLS

STAR, Kolb and Dotes

	STAR	Kolb’s learning cycle	Dotes
Built for	Answering one interview question	Describing how people learn from experience	**Recording what one person learned, in their own words**
Shape	A line: Situation, Task, Action, Result	A loop: experience, reflection, forming ideas, trying them out	**A spiral around Do, joining Show and Tell with Observe and Explore**
Leaves behind	One answer for one listener	Nothing; it’s a model, not a record	**A lasting, revisable record the person owns**

THE CATEGORIES

Seven lenses, not seven boxes

Character

What was at stake, and what did you choose?

Excellence

What were you working toward?

Service

Who or what did you help?

Relationships

How did the connection change?

Adventure

What was new, and what did it open up?

Making

What did you bring into being?

Wellbeing

What did you learn about living well?

For this room

One dote can sit under several lenses. What could you count across a thousand?

IN PAIRS · THREE MINUTES

Turn your card into a dote.

Do

What happened, and what did you do?

Observe

What went well, what didn’t, and what did you learn?

Time left? Try the Tell: how would you tell it at dinner? What’s the one detail someone would remember?

DISCUSSION · PICK THREE

Let’s argue about measurement.

1. What is the unit of measurement for meaning?
2. If people author the record, what happens to validity? Is self-report the flaw, or the point?
3. What could you count across a thousand dotes without reading anyone’s story?
4. Who should own learning evidence: the institution, the platform or the person?
5. Once stories count, will people perform them? How would you design against that?

What if the evidence belonged to the person who lived it?

Keep your card. It's yours.

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Michael Robbins · michael@intospatia.xyz · linkedin.com/in/mwrxyz